

Steven Boada, Ph.D

Basic Information	(615) 200-0119 stevenboada@gmail.com	github.com/boada linkedin.com/in/theboada
Professional Experience	Activision Publishing, Inc. Boulder, Colorado <i>Senior Data Scientist, Gameplay</i> January, 2024 – Present As part of the game science team, I work to make Call of Duty better through data. Currently, I am: - Working with senior design leadership to understand how players interact with Call of Duty gameplay systems. This includes maps, modes, movement, weapons, and in-game communication among others. - Leading initiatives to understand how game design affect topline KPIs, and suggest changes when appropriate. - Supporting infrastructure improvements to better track or diagnose gameplay related issues. <i>Senior Machine Learning Engineer</i> January, 2021 – 2024 - Designed, built, maintained, and improved ML infrastructure. This includes tool developement like autoML, CI/CD (Jenkins, github actions), model tracking and management (MLflow) and orchestration (Airflow). - Crafted and implimented policy around external data ingestion and data product retention for both my internal team and for sharing across the organization. - Designed, built, and maintained near-realtime applications (via Spark streaming) to combat in-game cheating and other malicious behavior. Typical time-to-action in the low 10s of seconds. - Lead the transition of ML infrastructure from AWS to GCP/GCS. - Created ML models to provide insights into customer conversion, churn, and behavioral segmentation. This leveraged survival analysis, clustering, as well as tree-based and linear methods. - Supervised junior team members to design and developed recommendation systems productionalized in both Modern Warfare 2 (2022) and Modern Warfare 3 (2023). <i>Insight Data Science Fellow</i> New York, New York January, 2020 – 2021 - Helped optimize the way NYC health inspectors perform restaurant inspections in order to reduce the time critical health violations remain unaddressed. - Trained a random forest in Python to prioritize NYC restaurant inspections based on environmental variables and their past inspection histories and provided the results to NYC through an API deployed on AWS. - Resulted in NYC inspectors identifying ~2.5% more violations in the first half of an inspection window, leading to critical violations being discovered up to 7 days earlier than by the current approach implemented by NYC. <i>Dept. of Physics and Astronomy, Rutgers University</i> New Brunswick, New Jersey <i>Postdoctoral Research Associate</i> September, 2016 – 2021 - Designed and built parallelized pipelines to process and analyze TBs of astronomical imaging; producing calibrated, standardized data catalogs and rigorous results leading to 2 peer reviewed publications and several hundred hours of telescope time. - Contributed to open source, astronomy-focused, Python projects through bug fixes and feature additions: see photometrypipeline, astLib, and easyGalaxy on GitHub as examples.	
Skills	Machine Learning: Linear Models, Decision Trees, SVM, Clustering, Deep Learning, Survival Analysis CI/CD: Jenkins, Airflow, Docker Software and Computing: Open Source Contributor, Python, DataBricks, MLFlow, SQL, AWS/GCP, Spark, and other cloud computing applications Leadership: Experience organizing and leading workshops and collaboration meetings, Teaching and mentoring junior team members, Eagle Scout.	
Education	Texas A&M University, College Station, Texas Ph.D, Physics (astronomy focus), 2016	The University of Tennessee, Knoxville, Tennessee - M.S., Physics (astronomy focus), 2009 - B.S., Physics, 2007